

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X
FITZROY ROBERTS,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE OFFICER
JANUEIL WRIGHT, SHIELD NO. 2087, NYPD POLICE
OFFICERS JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE THROUGH
TEN,

Defendants.
----- X

SUMMONS

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

Plaintiff designates King's
County as the place of trial.

To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
March 17, 2022

Yours, etc.

Cary London

Cary London, Esq.

Shulman-Hill, PLLC

Attorneys for Plaintiff

1 State Street Plaza

15th Floor

New York, New York 10004

(212) 203-1090

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
OFFICER JANUEIL WRIGHT, 81ST PCT, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

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INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Plaintiff Fitzroy Roberts, by his attorneys, Shulman-Hill, PLLC, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On July 22, 2021, at approximately 10:56 p.m., Plaintiff Fitzroy Roberts, while lawfully in the vicinity of 730 Willoughby Avenue, County of Kings, State of New York, was subject to an unlawful arrest, and detention by defendant Police Officers. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional, common law and statutory rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, detained, passed along false accusations to prosecuting attorneys and engaged in the malicious prosecution of Plaintiff, in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff Fitzroy Roberts is a resident of the state of New York.
3. NYPD Police Officer Janueil Wright, Shield No. 2087, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.
4. NYPD Police Officer Janueil Wright, Shield No. 2087, is being sued in their individual and official capacity.

5. Currently and at all times relevant herein, NYPD Police Officer Janueil Wright, Shield No. 2087 was assigned to the 81st Police Precinct of the NYPD.
6. NYPD Police Officers John Does Numbers One Through Ten are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.
7. NYPD Police Officers John Does Numbers One Through Ten are being sued in their individual and official capacities.
8. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.
9. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.
10. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the City of New York in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.
11. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, Plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on March 17, 2022.
12. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and the City of New York has failed to pay or adjust the claims.
13. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.
14. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

15. On July 22, 2021, at approximately 10:00 p.m., Plaintiff was walking out of his apartment in the vicinity of 730 Willoughby Avenue, County of Kings, State of New York, when the Defendant Police Officers unlawfully detained and arrested Plaintiff without legal justification.
16. Plaintiff was hired to film a music video at the above time and location in Kings County, New York.
17. Plaintiff is employed as a music video choreographer.
18. Plaintiff did not know everyone present at the music shoot.
19. There was a rented vehicle being used in the music video that Plaintiff had no association or prior contact with.
20. Defendant officers showed up while Plaintiff was standing outside of the rented vehicle.
21. There were approached plaintiff and told him to get back in the car.
22. Plaintiff informs Defendant officers that he was shooting a music video and was never in the car.
23. A Defendant officer shouts "Gun Gun" and Defendant officers arrest approximately 8 people present near the rented vehicle.
24. Plaintiff was transported to the 81st Precinct.
25. While Plaintiff was in custody, the Defendant police officers provided the Kings County District Attorney's Office with false, misleading and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed a crime.
26. Specifically, the defendant police officers falsely stated to the Kings County District Attorney's Office that Plaintiff possessed a firearm.
27. Plaintiff remained at the 81st Precinct for approximately 20 hours.
28. Plaintiff was transferred to Central Booking where he remained for approximately 24 hours.
29. Plaintiff saw the judge the next morning and was released on his own recognicence.
30. Plaintiff was unable to retrieve his phone until the case was dismissed.
31. Plaintiff was unable to contact his business clientele without his phone, and thus had lost earnings until he got his phone back.
32. All charges were dismissed and sealed on January 28, 2022.

33. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officers have an objective reason to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way.
34. At no point did Defendant Officers recover any drugs, weapons, graffiti instruments, or other illegal contraband from Plaintiff or from a location that was in Plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.
35. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause, unlawfully fingerprinted, photographed and searched, and unlawfully detained.
36. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably assaulting, battering, and using excessive force against Plaintiff.
37. The unlawful assault, battery, and use of excessive force by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligence

38. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
39. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.
40. Defendant Officer's breached that duty of care by deliberately restraining and injuring Plaintiff.
41. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, Defendant officers deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.
42. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault or provocation by Plaintiff.
43. Defendants officers were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
44. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
45. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION
Unlawful Stop, Question, and Search

46. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.
47. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and grab employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.
48. The conduct of defendants in approaching, stopping, and grabbing Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.
49. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.
50. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
51. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Unlawful Seizure and Deprivation of Liberty

52. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.
53. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.
54. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION
False Imprisonment

55. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

56. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.
57. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.
58. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
59. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.
60. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

61. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
62. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.
63. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.
64. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.
65. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
66. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

67. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

68. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
69. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.
70. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

71. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.
72. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.
73. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.
74. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, his property was damaged, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.
75. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.
76. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
77. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
78. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Violation of Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process**

79. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.
80. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.
81. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.
82. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.
83. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, Defendants violated Plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.
84. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.
85. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
86. The City, as the employer of the officer Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.
87. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of Defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries including, but not limited to: economic, emotional, and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Malicious Prosecution**

88. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.
89. The acts and conduct of the Defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the United States Constitution.
90. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against Plaintiff.

91. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceedings against Plaintiff and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.
92. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned date.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Defendant Officer's Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

93. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.
94. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.
95. The acts of Defendant Officers caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 8802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.
96. The Defendant Officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, frisked, and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately 12 hours in total.
97. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Defendant Officer's Failure to Intervene in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

98. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.
99. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.
100. Defendant Officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 8802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

101. The Defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8-8802 right against unreasonable search and seizure and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.
102. Defendant failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failing in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.
103. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendant described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

**City-Employer's Liability for Defendant Officer's Violation of
Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights**

104. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.
105. Defendant Officers are "covered individuals" as defined in 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 - 801 in that they are employees of the Police Department or persons appointed by the Police Commissioner as a Special Patrolmen.
106. The City of New York, as the employer of the covered individual Defendant Officers, is liable to the Plaintiff for the wrongdoing of the covered individual Defendant Officers.
107. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.
108. The acts of Defendant Officers caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.
109. The Defendant Officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, frisked, and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately 12 hours.
110. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

**City-Employer's Liability for Defendant Officer's Failure to
Intervene in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights**

111. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.
112. Defendant Officers are “covered individuals” as defined in 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 - 801 in that they are employees of the Police Department or persons appointed by the Police Commissioner as a Special Patrolmen.
113. The City of New York, as the employer of the covered individual Defendant Officers, is liable to the Plaintiff for the wrongdoing of the covered individual Defendant Officers.
114. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.
115. Defendant Officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.
116. The Defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff’s AC 8-802 rights against unreasonable search and seizure and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.
117. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.
118. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.
- 119.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Article I, § 12 of the New York State Constitution

120. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and, re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the above paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.
121. Such conduct breached the protections guaranteed to plaintiff by the New York State Constitution, including but not limited to, Article 1, §§ 1, 6, 8, 9, 11, and 12, and including the following rights:
 - i. freedom from unreasonable search and seizure of her person and property;
 - ii. freedom from arrest without probable cause;
 - iii. freedom from false imprisonment, that being wrongfully detained without good faith, reasonable suspicion, or legal justification, and of which wrongful detention plaintiff was aware and did not consent;

- iv. freedom from the lodging of false charges against him by police officers and prosecutors, including on information and belief, by some or all of the individual defendants; and
- v. freedom from deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

122. As a direct and proximate result of defendants' deprivations of Plaintiff's rights, privileges, and immunities guaranteed by the New York State Constitution, Plaintiff suffered physical, economic and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

123. As a result of the above tortious conduct, Plaintiff was caused to suffer physical, economic, and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

124. As a result of the above unconstitutional conduct, the City of New York is liable for the conduct of the Individual Defendants and any damages they caused under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

125. As a result of the above unconstitutional conduct, the City of New York is liable for the conduct of the Individual Defendants and any damages they caused under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

JURY DEMAND

126. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff Fitzroy Roberts demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law, and that the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
March 17, 2022

By: Cary London
Cary London, Esq.
Shulman-Hill, PLLC
Attorneys for Plaintiff
1 State Street Plaza
15th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 203-1090

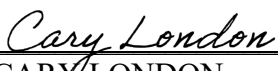
TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
OFFICER JANUEIL WRIGHT, 81ST PCT, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

CARY LONDON, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **SHULMAN-HILL PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
March 17, 2022



CARY LONDON